

User Study

Instructions for Grading. **PLEASE READ CAREFULLY.**

Imagine you are a user chatting with a chatbot service like Gemini, ChatGPT, DeepSeek etc. On each page you will see:

- A question: vague or ambiguous user message.
- Two clarification questions generated by different chatbots (labeled *Answer A* and *Answer B*) – these are follow-up questions the bot asked to better understand the user's intent.

Please rate each answer (answer A and answer B) on the following criteria :-

- **Precision and Focus:** How exactly the clarification question zeroes in on the missing detail or ambiguity in the original prompt. For example, responses providing examples to nudge the user to ask a more detailed question to the model.
- **Immediate Editability:** How easily you can rewrite your original prompt using only this question. For example, responses providing example choices to the user.
- **Contextual Fit:** How well the question aligns with the intent of the original programming task.

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a **scale from 1 to 5:**

"**1** = Strongly prefer **Answer A**"

"**5** = Strongly prefer **Answer B**"

"**3** = Both responses are equally good."

You will see **one Original Question per page**, with both answers visible at the same time.

Please read both answers carefully before rating.

You will complete **10 total evaluations**.

NOTE: The chatbots were forced to stop outputting text after 50 words. As a consequence, there may be some responses that look like they're cut off or incomplete. Kindly grade only the clarification question asked in Answer A and Answer B (ignoring irrelevant text; e.g., non-English like alphabets).

Question 1

I'm stuck on a part of my code.

Answer A: Could you please share a brief description of the code you're working on and what you're trying to achieve?

Apex

Answer B: Could you tell me a little bit about what part of your code you're stuck on, and what the code *should* be doing? Specifically, what's causing you trouble? (e.g., syntax errors, logic errors,

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):5

Contextual Fit (1-5):5

Question 2

Can someone explain how to optimize my code?

Answer A: Okay, let's clarify. To help you optimize your code effectively, could you tell me:

******What language are you using for your code, and what specific part of it are you finding slow or inefficient? (e.g., loops

Answer B: Okay, here's my question to better understand your prompt:

What kind of code are you working with? (e.g., Python, JavaScript, C++, etc.)

Knowing the language and the type of code you're

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):1

Immediate Editability (1-5):1

Contextual Fit (1-5):1

Question 3

JavaScript

```
function sendRequest(url) {  
  
    const xhr = new XMLHttpRequest();  
  
    xhr.open('GET', url);  
  
    // TODO: Add onload handler  
  
}
```

Answer A: What is the intended purpose of the function `sendRequest` within the context of web development? Specifically, what action or data are you hoping to send to the URL specified in the function?

Johnathan.

Answer B: What is the purpose of this `sendRequest` function? (e.g., is it intended to send a request to a server, fetch data, etc.?)

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):1

Immediate Editability (1-5):1

Contextual Fit (1-5):1

Question 4

Python

```
import numpy as np

def compute_mean(data):

    return np.mean(data)

# Missing data check

print(compute_mean())
```

Answer A: What kind of data is being provided as input to the `compute_mean` function? (e.g., a list of numbers, a NumPy array, etc.)

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Answer B: Okay, let's clarify what you're trying to achieve with this code snippet. The code snippet appears to be a simple function designed to calculate the mean of a list of numbers. However, it's missing the crucial part – **

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):1

Immediate Editability (1-5):1

Contextual Fit (1-5):1

Question 5

I need guidance on a library.

Answer A: Okay, to help me guide you effectively, could you tell me **what kind of library are you looking for?** (e.g., public library, university library, local history library, etc.)

allows me to tailor my response

Answer B: Okay, let's figure out the best way to approach this. To help me understand your needs, could you tell me:

- **What kind of library are you looking for?** (e.g., public library, school library

Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):3

Immediate Editability (1-5):3

Contextual Fit (1-5):3

Question 6

I'm having trouble with my function.

Answer A: Okay, let's break down the problem. To help me understand what's going wrong and how to fix it, could you tell me:

1. **What language/programming language are you using for your function?** (e

Answer B: Okay, I understand you're having trouble with your function.

Could you please describe the function itself and what you're trying to achieve with it?

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):5

Contextual Fit (1-5):5

Question 7

Python

```
def calculate_area(radius):  
  
    return 3.14 * radius ** 2  
  
# TODO: Handle negative radius  
  
area = calculate_area(-5)
```

Answer A: Okay, let's clarify the purpose of the code and the desired behavior. Could you tell me what the intended use of the `calculate_area` function is? For example, what type of area are you trying to calculate (e

Answer B: What is the expected behavior when a negative radius is provided as input to the `calculate_area` function? 做到

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):5

Contextual Fit (1-5):5

Question 8

Python

```
from flask import Flask

app = Flask(__name__)

@app.route('/')

# TODO: Add a view function


def main():

    return 'Hello World'
```

Answer A: What specific functionality or purpose are you hoping this Flask app will serve? For example, do you want to handle user input, interact with a database, or something else entirely? Knowing the intended interaction with the user or data will help me refine the

Answer B: What is the intended purpose of this Flask application? (e.g., a simple website, a web service, etc.)

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):1

Immediate Editability (1-5):1

Contextual Fit (1-5):1

Question 9

Python

```
class User:

    def __init__(self, name, age):

        self.name = name

        self.age = age

user = User('Alice', ) # TODO: specify age
```

Answer A: What age should the `User` object have initially, and what's the intended purpose of the age attribute in this class?

John!

Specifically, are you intending to store the age as an integer, or is there a reason you

Answer B: What is the intended purpose of this code snippet? (e.g., is it meant to create a user object, or something else?)

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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):1

Immediate Editability (1-5):1

Contextual Fit (1-5):1

Question 10

Python

```
while True:

    print('Running...')

    if not condition:

        break  // TODO: Define condition
```

Answer A: What is the intended purpose of the code snippet? (e.g., is it a loop, a conditional statement, a game loop, etc.?)
interior Scientistsancake

Answer B: What is the purpose of the code snippet you're referring to? What condition is being checked within the `if not condition` block?
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Your response:

How to rate:

You will be asked to give a score on a scale from 1 to 5:

"1 = Strongly prefer Answer A"

"5 = Strongly prefer Answer B"

"3 = Both responses are equally good."

Precision and Focus (1-5):5

Immediate Editability (1-5):5

Contextual Fit (1-5):5